

ArchPop Rentals

Self-inflating balloon arches. 15-minute setup. Hundreds per event.

What It Is

ArchPop Rentals is a balloon-decoration business built around self-inflating arch machines: you load the balloons, flip the pump, and a perfect arch builds itself in under a minute — no tying, taping, or hours of labor. The twist most people miss is the rental angle: instead of selling decor one-off, you own a few machines and rent setups per event, showing up to install in 15 minutes and leaving while you collect the fee.

How It Makes Money

You charge per-event for balloon arch setups at birthdays, weddings, baby showers, grand openings, and corporate parties — typically \$200-\$650 per arch depending on size and balloons. Owning 2-3 machines lets you book multiple events a weekend. Revenue is the install fee plus balloon/material markup. Upsell backdrops, neon signs, flower add-ons, and full party-decor packages.

Startup Costs

- Self-inflating arch machine x2-3: \$300-\$1,200 total
- Balloon inventory (assorted colors/sizes, bulk): \$200-\$500
- Backdrops, stands, clips, accessories: \$200-\$600
- Air pump / electric inflator: \$40-\$120
- Transport bins + branding on vehicle/setup: \$150-\$500
- Simple booking site (GoHighLevel): \$97/month
- Local ads / launch budget: \$200-\$600
- **Realistic start: \$1,200-\$3,500**

Sourcing: Buy machines and balloons from Alibaba — search "automatic balloon arch making machine," "electric balloon inflator pump," and "balloon garland kit bulk." Machines land around \$120-\$400 each; bulk balloons are cents apiece.

The Numbers

- Material cost per event (balloons + consumables): ~\$25-\$60
- Sell price per setup: \$250-\$600
- Profit per event: ~\$200-\$540 (minus ~30-60 min of your time)
- Slow month (part-time, weekends): 8 events → ~\$2,200 profit
- Busy month (referrals + multiple machines): 25-35 events → ~\$7,000-\$12,000 profit
- Each machine pays for itself in 1-2 bookings.

How To Start

1. Buy 1-2 arch machines and a starter balloon inventory; practice until setup is fast and clean.
2. Build a portfolio — decorate 3-5 setups (even free for friends) and photograph them well.
3. Stand up a GoHighLevel booking page with packages, gallery, and online deposit.

4. Set tiered pricing (standard, deluxe, full party package) and a clear service area.
5. List on Google Business, Yelp, and local event/party Facebook groups.
6. Partner with venues, event planners, and bakeries for referrals.
7. Reinvest into a 3rd machine and add-ons (neon signs, backdrops) to raise ticket size.

Where To Get Customers

- Instagram and TikTok — post every finished arch; party decor is highly shareable
- Local Facebook groups for moms, events, and party planning
- Google Business Profile + "balloon arch near me" search
- Referral deals with venues, photographers, and event planners
- Wedding/quinceañera/baby-shower directories and expos

Pro Tips

- Sell packages, not single arches — pair the arch with a backdrop and neon sign to double your per-event revenue.
- Lock in venue and event-planner partnerships; repeat referral channels beat paid ads for this business.
- Photograph every single setup in good light — your Instagram grid is your storefront and closes most bookings.